

# Tsenguunjav Byambasuren

(Last update: May 2026)

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| CONTACT                 | Trinity College Dublin<br>Department of Economics<br>3158 Arts Building, College Green<br>Dublin 2, Ireland                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | byambast@tcd.ie<br><a href="https://sites.google.com/view/tsenguunjavbyambasuren/">https://sites.google.com/view/tsenguunjavbyambasuren/</a> |
| ACADEMIC<br>APPOINTMENT | <b>Trinity College Dublin</b> , Dublin, Ireland<br>Assistant Professor in Economics, 2025 – present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                              |
| EDUCATION               | <b>Cornell University</b> , Ithaca, NY<br>Ph.D. in Applied Economics and Management, 2019 – 2025<br>Dissertation: “Essays on Labor Market Power”<br>Dissertation Committee: Nancy H. Chau (Chair), Arnab K. Basu, Michele Belot, Ravi Kanbur<br>Dyson Best PhD Dissertation Award, Cornell University<br><br><b>Cornell University</b> , Ithaca, NY<br>Master of Science in Applied Economics and Management, 2017 – 2019<br><br><b>University of Finance and Economics</b> , Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia<br>Bachelor of Science in Economics (with distinction), 2009 – 2013                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                              |
| FIELDS                  | Labor Economics, Development Economics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                              |
| AFFILIATIONS            | Trinity College Dublin, Trinity Impact Evaluation Unit (TIME)<br>Affiliate Member, 2026 – present<br><br>Monash University, Centre of Excellence for the Elimination of Violence Against Women (CEVAW)<br>Research Affiliate, 2025 – present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                              |
| PUBLISHED<br>PAPERS     | “Cooking Fuel Choice and Child Mortality in India”<br>(with Arnab K. Basu, Nancy H. Chau and Neha Khanna)<br><i>Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization</i> , 2024, 222: 240-265.<br>Featured in Cornell Chronicle, The Hindu, The Times of India, Times Now, Press Trust of India,<br>Medical Xpress<br>George F. Warren Award for Outstanding Paper, Cornell University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                              |
| WORKING<br>PAPERS       | <b>“Automation Threat and Labor Market Power”</b><br>This paper studies the role of automation threat in firms’ labor market power. Employing the production approach, I show that workers in an average German manufacturer receive 79 cents on the marginal euro. Using automation threat proxied by local labor market regions’ exposure to industrial robots instrumented by plausibly exogenous shift-share factors, I find that robot exposure increases employer power over routine workers in areas with weaker unions in East Germany with spatial frictions. The empirical findings are consistent with the wage bargaining model where employers retain the “right-to-manage” their workforce composition and unions representing different workers separately bargain with the firm. |                                                                                                                                              |

**“Alcohol Consumption and Intimate Partner Violence: Long-Term Effects of a Temporary Alcohol Ban”** (with Arnab K. Basu and Nancy H. Chau), *Under Review*

We trace the impact of a temporary ban targeting liquor-serving bars – from launch to reversal – on alcohol consumption and women’s experience with domestic violence in Kerala, India. Decomposing the policy-induced and reversal effects by employing difference-in-differences and event-study approaches, we identify a significant reduction in alcohol consumption (but only in bars) with an accompanying reduction in intimate partner violence during the policy period. However, both alcohol consumption and domestic violence rebounded to pre-ban levels after the policy removal. Heterogeneity analysis further reveals these effects to be confined only amongst high-wealth households. A battery of robustness tests confirms our findings.

**“Public Works Program, Labor Supply, and Monopsony”** (with Nancy H. Chau and Vidhya Soundararajan)

This paper studies the role of changes in workforce composition in monopsony power. We develop a monopsony model in which a firm’s wage markdown—the wedge between MRPL and wage—is a weighted average of markdowns for heterogeneous workers. We empirically illustrate the theory using India’s National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (NREGA), which generates non-manufacturing jobs in rural areas. Consistent with the model predictions, at manufacturing firms, we find that the program increases average markdowns by crowding out mobile workers and effectively increasing the share of immobile workers with low labor supply elasticity.

**“Artisanal Mining, Female Labor Supply, and Intimate Partner Violence”** (with Anh Nguyen)

This paper uses micro data from over 30 countries in Sub-Saharan Africa to present nearly continent-wide evidence that the rise in the potential value of artisanal mining leads to a structural transformation from the agricultural to the non-agricultural sectors. Leveraging spatial variation in gold suitability and exogenous temporal variation in global gold prices, we show that employment activities in the mining and retail industries increase more for women than men. An increase in women’s intrahousehold bargaining power results in a decrease in violence within the household, ruling out a potential backlash effect.

RESEARCH IN  
PROGRESS

**“Capital Market Integration, Labor Market Distortions, and Labor Misallocation”** (with Nancy H. Chau, Anh Nguyen and Vidhya Soundararajan)

**“Services Liberalization, Monopsony, and Gender”** (with Anh Nguyen)

**“Gold Mining, Child Labor, and Education”** (with Anh Nguyen)

**“The Effects of Extreme Heat on Gender Gap in Labor Supply”** (with Avralt-Od Purevjav and William Seitz)

DISCUSSIONS

2024 NEUDC Conference Discussant: “Global Labor Market Power” by Amodio, Brancati, Brummund, de Roux, and Di Maio

2023 MWIEDC Conference Discussant: “Family Planning and the Female Labor Supply: Evidence from Urban Malawi” by Karra, Maggio, and Canning

POLICY  
WORK

“Leveraging Geospatial Techniques and Publicly Available Datasets to Develop a Cost-Effective, Digitized National Sampling Frame: A Case Study of Armenia”

(with Saida Ismailkhunova, Avralt-Od Purevjav and Sarchil Qader)

*ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information*, 2026, 15(4): 145.

Featured in Devdiscourse

“Listening to Georgia and Armenia: Baseline and Phone Surveys and Analyses”

(with Saida Ismailkhunova, Avralt-Od Purevjav and others)

“Poverty and Equity Assessment for Georgia”

(with Saida Ismailakhunova and others)

“Distributional Impact of Energy Tariff Reforms in the Republic of Georgia”

(with Saida Ismailakhunova, Avralt-Od Purevjav and Juan Carlos Palacios Mora)

PRESENTATIONS 2027: LERA@ASSA Annual Meeting in Washington, DC (scheduled), SEHO@ASSA Annual Meeting in Washington, DC (scheduled)

2026: ASSA Annual Meeting in Philadelphia, Irish Postgraduate and Early Career Economics Workshop at Maynooth University, Trinity College Dublin, Irish Economic Association Annual Conference, World Inequality Conference at Paris School of Economics (scheduled), Barcelona School of Economics Summer Forum (scheduled), EEA Annual Meeting at University College Dublin (scheduled), Aarhus University (scheduled)

2025: ASSA Annual Meeting in San Francisco, University of Georgia, 16th IAB PhD Workshop in Nuremberg, UNU-WIDER Development Conference in Helsinki, Trinity College Dublin, 6th World Labor Conference in Toronto, 11th Conference of the Society for the Study of Economic Inequality (ECINEQ) at the World Bank, Work in Progress Seminar at Trinity College Dublin (x2)

2024: STEG Annual Conference at NYU Abu Dhabi, MWIEDC Conference at the University of Chicago, SOLE Annual Meeting in Portland OR, Online Africa Meeting of the Econometric Society, EEA-ESEM Annual Meeting at Erasmus School of Economics, EALE Conference at Norwegian School of Economics, AEP Seminar at Cornell University, NEUDC Conference at Northeastern University

2023: PacDev Conference at the University of Washington, MWIEDC Conference at the University of Houston, 24th IZA Summer School in Labor Economics in Berlin

2022: WEAI Annual Conference in Portland OR, APPAM Fall Research Conference in Washington DC, 17th Annual Conference at Indian Statistical Institute

PROFESSIONAL  
ACTIVITIES

Referee Service:

Journal of Population Economics, Review of Economics of the Household

University/Departmental Services:

Incoming Exchange Coordinator for Economics, 2026 – present

PhD Economics Admission Committee, Trinity College Dublin, 2025 – 2026

MSc Economics Admission Committee, Trinity College Dublin, 2025 – 2026

Undergraduate Best Capstone Project Selection Committee, Trinity College Dublin, 2025 – 2026

Professional Association Membership:

American Economic Association, Member, 2024 – present

European Economic Association, Member, 2024 – present

The Econometric Society, Member, 2023 – 2025

Cornell Center for Social Sciences, Affiliated Student, 2023 – 2025

Cornell University, Diversity in Cornell Economics (DICE), General Member, 2022 – 2025

STUDENT  
ADVISING

**Trinity College Dublin**, Dublin, Ireland

MSc Economics Thesis:

Ongoing: Leena Osman

Undergraduate Economics Thesis:

Shayna Arbab, Saorla Chadwick, Laoise Clifford, Elaine Farnan, Alexandra Lockard, Aine Marnane

AWARDS,  
GRANTS, AND  
FELLOWSHIPS

|                                                                          |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Cornell Graduate School Conference Travel Grant (x5)                     | 2022 – 2025 |
| IAB PhD Workshop Travel Grant, Germany                                   | 2025        |
| Graduate Fellowship, Dyson School, Cornell                               | 2019, 2024  |
| EEA Travel Grant, European Economic Association                          | 2024        |
| Dyson Graduate Teaching Assistant – Outstanding Service Award, Cornell   | 2024        |
| Graduate Teaching Assistant Fellowship, Dyson School, Cornell            | 2020 – 2024 |
| Graduate Assistant Fellowship, Dyson School, Cornell                     | 2020 – 2023 |
| Summer Internship Grant (declined), CIPA, Cornell                        | 2018        |
| Tuition Fellowship, Cornell Institute for Public Affairs (CIPA), Cornell | 2017 – 2018 |
| Dean's List, University of Finance and Economics, Mongolia               | 2010 – 2012 |

TEACHING  
EXPERIENCE

**Trinity College Dublin**, Dublin, Ireland

|                                                                         |             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Econometrics I (MSc in Economics, ECP77001)                             | Fall 2026   |
| Introduction to Microeconomics (MSc in Economics, ECP77003)             | Fall 2026   |
| Intermediate Economics B (Undergraduate, ECU22012)                      | Spring 2026 |
| Introduction to Economic Policy B (Undergraduate, ECU11034)             | Spring 2026 |
| Economics Capstone (Undergraduate Thesis, ECU44100)                     | 2025 – 2026 |
| Quantitative Methods for Economics I (MSc in Economic Policy, ECP77211) | Fall 2025   |

**Cornell University**, Ithaca, NY

|                                                                            |                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| International Trade and Finance (Undergraduate, AEM/ECON 2300)             |                  |
| Coordinating Teaching Assistant to Professor Arnab K. Basu                 | Spring 2025      |
| Teaching Assistant to Professor Arnab K. Basu                              | Spring 2022-2024 |
| Teaching Assistant to Professor David R. Lee                               | Spring 2021      |
| Introduction to Macroeconomic Theory and Policy (Undergraduate, AEM 1300)  | Summer 2024/2025 |
| Coordinating Teaching Assistant to Professor Arnab K. Basu                 |                  |
| Applied Managerial Economics (Undergraduate, AEM 4100)                     | Fall 2022/2023   |
| Teaching Assistant to Professor Terry Alexander                            |                  |
| Research and Methods (Master of Professional Studies, AEM 6991)            | Fall 2021        |
| Teaching Assistant to Professors Mark Constas, Aija Leiponen, Daniela Scur |                  |
| Consumer Behavior (Undergraduate, AEM 3440)                                | Fall 2020        |
| Teaching Assistant to Professor Alison Shields                             |                  |

OTHER  
EMPLOYMENT

|                                                                         |                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Consultant, Poverty and Equity Group, The World Bank                    | 2023 – present   |
| Research Assistant to Professor Nancy H. Chau                           | 2018, 2023, 2025 |
| Research Assistant to Professor Arnab K. Basu                           | 2022             |
| Research Assistant to Professor Eswar Prasad                            | 2019             |
| Summer Intern, Global Indicators Group, The World Bank                  | 2019             |
| Economist, Research and Statistics Department, Central Bank of Mongolia | 2013 – 2017      |